

Run Linux on Windows ⁱⁿ

Part II



Yes, it's possible with the Ulteo Virtual Desktop.

In the first part of this article, published in the November 2008 issue of *LFY*, we looked at how to use a feature in Ubuntu that lets you install it just like a typical Windows application. Once installed, you can simply reboot your system into the world of Linux—there's no partitioning and other techie fiddling around required.

The downside there was the “reboot to use Linux”. Well, what if I tell you that there's a way to run Linux from inside Windows without a reboot? No, I'm certainly not talking about virtual machines and virtualisation here, but something as simple as a typical

click-next application installation procedure.

Allow me to introduce you to something called Ulteo Virtual Desktop [www.ulteo.com], an open source application that nicely integrates into your Windows operating system and allows you to work on a full Linux system. Its main benefit is that you can run Linux and Windows applications simultaneously within the same desktop environment without rebooting the system.

Ready, steady, go!

Before starting the installation, let's look at the hardware and software requirements. According to the website [www.ulteo.com], “Ulteo Virtual Desktop requires a x86-based PC with a modern 32-bit CPU and at least 512 MB RAM. A minimum of 4 GB of free HD space is required.” This is certainly not asking too much, I guess. My test system has the following specs:

- Pentium 4 with HT technology
- An Intel 865 motherboard
- 1 GB RAM

You can download the Ulteo VD from its website. There are two types of Ulteo products—Ulteo Application System is an installable live CD that offers a Windows alternative, and Ulteo Virtual Desktop is a coLinux-based Virtualised Ulteo workstation, which you can install on Windows. Its setup file is about 510 MB in size. It supports a full range of Linux applications, like Firefox, OpenOffice.org, KPDF, Skype, Thunderbird,

List of readily available apps

Software category	Available applications
Graphics	The GIMP, Gwenview, Inkscape, Kpdf, Ksnapshot, digiKam, showFoto
Internet	Firefox, KFTPGrabber, KTorrent, Konqueror, Kopete, Krdc, Krfb, Thunderbird, Skype, Sun Java 5.0 Web Start
Multimedia	KMix, KsCD, VLC media player, Amarok
Office	KMyMoney, OpenOffice.org (Base, Calc, Impress, Writer)
System	KBFX Configurator, KInfoCenter, KSysGuard, Keep, Konsole
Utilities	Ark, KAm, KGpg, Kjobviewer, KNotes, Kate, Skim
Settings	Appearance & Themes, Desktop, Internet & Network, KDE components, Peripherals, Security & Privacy, Sound & Multimedia, Systems Administration

Table 1